

Q: Could a government-to-government approach help DP World's plans in India? Have you raised it, and what was the response?
A: It can. Yes, we have. It is working to some extent. But the litigative nature, the ability of people to stop things from happening, is what prevents people to go down a path which can be questioned. Everything gets challenged. Even simple stuff. And that is where we need to find breakthroughs. So I am a willing investor. You want Vadhvan? You wanted it five years ago? Why did it not happen? You should know. I am prepared to do it tomorrow. I have the money. I am a leading global operator. I do all these things for so many people. Why is it not happening? Why would you not take my cheque?

Q: Is it competition at play?
A:. That I don't know. All I know is, well, give it to them. Let them put the money and do it. Don't make the country suffer.

Q: Across your global footprint, where does India stand on ease of doing business and investor friendliness?
A:The world is a very relative place. Everybody wants to do business in India. From what I understand, even India wants foreign direct investment and wants to manufacture for the world. So, there is no divergence. How can we make sure that it happens at a pace where the potential will be realised in the quickest possible time?

Now, it is not as easily done because we are just coming through a phase of extensive weaponisation, which creates an almost national security type of risk for nations. But we have to make that leap of faith. India can do it at scale. India has the market. So when you want to manufacture for the world, you need a place which has a substantive market on its own. Progress, as I said, has been made. But why is the money not flowing into India?

Q: After more than two decades at DP World, what is your future agenda?
A: We are clearly very stable because we are very diversified. Our strength is our people. Personally, I am blessed that I have the confidence of the shareholders. We have had the freedom to operate and have created a phenomenal business. We believe globalisation is here to stay. Alliances will keep shifting. And the new world order will come. Just don't ask me whether it's going to be in three months or six months. What I can guarantee you is we will be alive and will outlast this period of uncertainty.

Q: What does it mean to be an Indian-origin CEO of such a global company?
A: I feel blessed for the confidence placed in me by the government of Dubai. Like many other Indian origin CEOs of global businesses, I am proud of the people and the business I lead.

Q: Are Indians great managers of chaos?
A: We are great survivors in chaos. BT

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